

Supply Chain and Logistics English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: supply-chain managers, planners, buyers, logistics coordinators, warehouse leaders, procurement teams, customs staff, and operations managers

Focus: A supply-chain English curriculum for forecasting, shortages, purchasing, inventory, warehouse operations, logistics delays, supplier performance, customs, risk, and crisis communication.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Demand Planning and Forecast Bias

Situation

Sales raises the forecast after a promotion begins.

Stakeholder pressure: Increase production commitments immediately.

Constraint: Forecast bias, lead time, capacity, and inventory exposure need review.

Terms to use

- forecast
- forecast bias
- demand signal
- S&OP

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Sales raises the forecast after a promotion begins.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Increase production commitments immediately.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm forecast, forecast bias, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	demand-planning exception note
C	S&OP decision summary
D	evidence

Module 2. Procurement and Supplier Performance

Situation

A supplier misses delivery but promises recovery next week.

Stakeholder pressure: Accept the promise and update the plan.

Constraint: Capacity, allocation, purchase order terms, and recovery evidence are unclear.

Terms to use

- purchase order
- lead time
- OTIF
- allocation

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A supplier misses delivery but promises recovery next week.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Accept the promise and update the plan.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm purchase order, lead time, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	fulfillment recovery update
B	supplier recovery plan
C	demand-planning exception note
D	inventory segmentation memo

Module 3. Inventory, Safety Stock, and Service Levels**Situation**

Finance wants to reduce inventory across all SKUs.

Stakeholder pressure: Cut safety stock by the same percentage.

Constraint: Demand variability, lead time, margin, service level, and stockout risk differ by item.

Terms to use

- safety stock
- stockout
- service level

- SKU

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Finance wants to reduce inventory across all SKUs.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Cut safety stock by the same percentage.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm safety stock, stockout, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	scope
B	inventory segmentation memo
C	risk
D	owner

Module 4. Warehousing and Fulfillment

Situation

Orders are late because pick accuracy is falling.

Stakeholder pressure: Add overtime until backlog clears.

Constraint: Slotting, labor, scanner data, training, and error types need diagnosis.

Terms to use

- pick rate
- slotting
- cycle count
- backlog

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Orders are late because pick accuracy is falling.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Add overtime until backlog clears.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm pick rate, slotting, the owner, and the evidence standard.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	S&OP decision summary
B	evidence
C	risk
D	fulfillment recovery update

Module 5. Freight, Routing, and Carrier Delays

Situation

A carrier misses pickup before a major customer shipment.

Stakeholder pressure: Blame the carrier and wait.

Constraint: Mode, route, cutoff time, expedite cost, and customer promise need a decision.

Terms to use

- incoterms
- carrier
- expedite
- ETA

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A carrier misses pickup before a major customer shipment.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Blame the carrier and wait.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm incoterms, carrier, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	freight escalation notice
B	evidence
C	risk

Option	Phrase
D	owner

Module 6. Customs, Trade Compliance, and Documentation

Situation

A shipment is held because the commercial invoice has inconsistent data.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask customs to release it anyway.

Constraint: Classification, country of origin, valuation, and document consistency matter.

Terms to use

- HS code
- country of origin
- commercial invoice
- broker

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A shipment is held because the commercial invoice has inconsistent data.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask customs to release it anyway.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm HS code, country of origin, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	supplier recovery plan
B	inventory segmentation memo
C	customs hold response
D	demand-planning exception note

Module 7. Supply Risk and Business Continuity

Situation

A port strike threatens inbound components.

Stakeholder pressure: Promise no customer impact.

Constraint: Allocation, alternate sources, inventory position, and customer priority need governance.

Terms to use

- business continuity
- dual sourcing
- allocation
- constraint

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A port strike threatens inbound components.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Promise no customer impact.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm business continuity, dual sourcing, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	disclosure
B	demand-planning exception note
C	supplier recovery plan
D	supply risk brief

Module 8. Executive S&OP Decisions**Situation**

Sales, finance, and operations disagree on next quarter's plan.

Stakeholder pressure: Use the most optimistic demand view.

Constraint: The executive team must agree on assumptions, risk, upside, and owners.

Terms to use

- S&OP
- consensus plan
- scenario
- owner

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

Sales, finance, and operations disagree on next quarter's plan.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use the most optimistic demand view.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm S&OP, consensus plan, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	supply risk brief
B	S&OP decision summary
C	freight escalation notice
D	customs hold response

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Demand Planning and Forecast Bias

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. demand-planning exception note	A demand-planning exception note is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Procurement and Supplier Performance

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. supplier recovery plan	A supplier recovery plan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Inventory, Safety Stock, and Service Levels

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. inventory segmentation memo	A inventory segmentation memo is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Warehousing and Fulfillment

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. fulfillment recovery update	A fulfillment recovery update is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Freight, Routing, and Carrier Delays

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. freight escalation notice	A freight escalation notice is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Customs, Trade Compliance, and Documentation

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. customs hold response	A customs hold response is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Supply Risk and Business Continuity

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. supply risk brief	A supply risk brief is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Executive S&OP Decisions

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. S&OP decision summary	A S&OP decision summary is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.